

Wealth Strategy Snapshot

Educational Analysis

2026 Tax Year Planning | Prepared for Jeanette Diaz Bozek & Ryan Bozek | February 2026

Educational scenario modeling for discussion with licensed professionals

Executive Summary

This analysis explores tax optimization strategies and investment concepts for the 2026 tax year, tailored to your financial profile. Based on the information provided, this snapshot identifies opportunities across retirement account maximization, business deductions, and wealth-building vehicles that may align with your goals of reducing taxes, improving cash flow, and building long-term wealth.

The strategies outlined focus on maximizing Ryan's underutilized 457(b) deferred compensation plan, optimizing Jeanette's 403(b) contributions, exploring Backdoor Roth IRAs for both spouses, and implementing business deductions for the LLC. This snapshot models potential first-year value ranging from **\$77,416** (conservative scenario) to **\$111,015** (aggressive scenario). Implementation of any strategy should be verified with your CPA and licensed financial advisor.

Modeled First-Year Value Range (2026)

\$77,416 – \$111,015

Current Financial Position

HOUSEHOLD INCOME Combined W-2: \$150-199K Side Business (LLC): ~\$7K gross	FILING STATUS & AGE Married Filing Jointly Age 48 (no catch-up eligible yet)
LOCATION Fort Collins, CO State Tax Rate: 4.4%	ESTIMATED MARGINAL RATE ~26.4% Combined (22% Federal + 4.4% CO)
BUSINESS STRUCTURE Single-Member LLC (Sole Prop) Red Cross Safety Training	EMPLOYMENT Ryan: Denver Fire Dept (26 yrs) Jeanette: Part-time W-2 (\$30K)

Current Assets & Accounts

Asset Type	Current Value	Notes
Combined Roth IRAs	~\$600,000	Primary retirement savings vehicle to date
Emergency Fund	\$11,543	Checking/savings
Home Equity	\$100,000+	Home value ~\$430K; P&I \$2,200/mo
529 Plans	~\$16,000	\$10K + \$6K for two younger children
Bitcoin (River Financial)	Small position	Recently started \$50/paycheck DCA
403(b) - Jeanette	New (Nov 2024)	Replaced \$220/mo Roth; 50% match on first 2%
457(b) Deferred Comp - Ryan	\$0 (unused)	Available through Denver Fire; historically avoided due to fees

Current Fixed Obligations

Obligation	Monthly Amount	Notes
Mortgage (P&I only)	\$2,200	Taxes and insurance paid separately
Car Payment (Hybrid)	\$293	\$17,000 remaining; for Ryan's commute
College Support (Son)	~\$2,800	Aviation/commercial pilot degree; ~6-18 mo remaining

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Wealth Strategy Snapshot - Bozek Family - 2026

Son's Rent & Food	\$1,275	\$875 rent + \$400 food; temporary
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Key Profile Observations

- **Significant Untapped Tax Shelter:** Ryan's 457(b) allows \$24,500/year in pre-tax deferrals - currently unused
- **Strong Roth Foundation:** \$600K in Roths provides tax-free growth and withdrawal flexibility
- **Temporary Cash Flow Pressure:** ~\$4,075/mo college support is significant but time-limited (6-18 months)
- **Home Equity Available:** \$100K+ equity could enable HELOC for future opportunities
- **Time Available:** 5-10 hours/week for wealth-building activities
- **Risk Tolerance:** Moderately aggressive; growth-focused with volatility acceptance

Timeline Awareness & Implementation Considerations (2026 Planning)

The following timeline items are provided for calendar awareness. Verify applicability and timing with your tax professional before taking any action.

Week 1

- 457(b) consideration: Review current plan fees with Denver Fire HR; fees have likely decreased significantly since Ryan started 26 years ago
- Verify 403(b) contribution room remaining for 2026
- Gather 2025 tax documents

Week 2

- Discuss increasing Jeanette's 403(b) contribution percentage with HR
- Consider 2025 IRA contributions (April 15 deadline) - discuss with CPA
- Review W-4 withholding for potential optimization

Week 3

- Research Backdoor Roth IRA process for both spouses
- Measure home office square footage for deduction documentation
- Download mileage tracking app (MileIQ, Everlance)

Week 4

- Augusta Rule: Research fair rental value for home if considering business meetings
- Review car loan: payoff vs. continue payments analysis
- Schedule CPA consultation for Q2 tax planning

These timeline items are for awareness and discussion purposes. Verify applicability and implementation details with your CPA and financial advisor before proceeding.

2025 Tax Year: Remaining Opportunities (Before April 15, 2026)

2025 Strategies Still Available

The following 2025 contributions can still be made until April 15, 2026:

Strategy	2025 Limit	Deadline	Your Potential Opportunity
Traditional/Roth IRA	\$7,000 per spouse	April 15, 2026	Up to \$14,000 combined (verify income limits for direct Roth)
HSA Contributions	\$8,550 family / \$4,300 individual	April 15, 2026	Not applicable (no HDHP currently)
Solo 401(k) Employer Portion	25% of net SE income	Tax filing + extensions	~\$1,000 if Solo 401(k) was established
SEP IRA	25% up to \$69,000	Tax filing + extensions	Alternative if no Solo 401(k) exists

No Longer Available for 2025: 401(k)/403(b)/457(b) employee deferrals (December 31, 2025 deadline passed), W-4 adjustments (only affect 2026 forward), Augusta Rule rentals (must have occurred in 2025).

Verify 2025 contribution eligibility with your CPA. Making prior-year contributions requires careful coordination with your tax return.

2026 Tax Optimization Strategies to Explore

Strategy Concept: 457(b) Deferred Compensation (Ryan)

Potential Value: \$6,468 tax savings

What It Is: A 457(b) is a tax-deferred retirement plan available to government employees. Contributing reduces taxable income dollar-for-dollar. At your 26.4% marginal rate, a \$24,500 contribution creates approximately \$6,468 in tax savings for 2026.

How It Works:

1. Contact Denver Fire HR to review current 457(b) plan options and fee structure (fees have typically decreased significantly over 26 years)
2. Elect contribution amount through payroll; contributions reduce each paycheck proportionally
3. Funds grow tax-deferred until withdrawal in retirement

Eligibility Criteria: Government employee (Denver Fire qualifies); no income limits; can contribute to BOTH 457(b) and 403(b) simultaneously with separate limits.

Key Advantage: 457(b) has NO 10% early withdrawal penalty, making it more flexible than 401(k)/403(b) for early retirement access.

Verify plan details with Denver Fire HR. 2026 limit: \$24,500 (no catch-up until age 50). Discuss with your CPA and financial advisor before proceeding.

Strategy Concept: 403(b) Maximization (Jeanette)

Potential Value: \$3,168 - \$6,468 tax savings

What It Is: A 403(b) is a retirement plan for nonprofit and public sector employees. Jeanette's employer matches 50% on the first 2% of salary, providing free employer contributions. At 26.4% marginal rate, contributions of \$12,000-\$24,500 model potential tax savings of \$3,168-\$6,468.

How It Works:

1. Increase contribution percentage through HR to capture full employer match (currently getting 50% on first 2%)
2. Consider increasing beyond match up to \$24,500 limit if cash flow allows
3. This replaces Jeanette's previous \$220/mo Roth contribution while providing immediate tax benefit

Eligibility Criteria: Employee of qualifying organization; Jeanette already enrolled (November 2024).

Verify current contribution amount and match details with employer. 2026 limit: \$24,500 (no catch-up until age 50). Discuss timing with your CPA.

Strategy Concept: Backdoor Roth IRA (Both Spouses)

Potential Value: \$15,000 positioned tax-free growth

What It Is: A strategy allowing high-income earners to contribute to Roth IRA regardless of income limits. Involves non-deductible Traditional IRA contribution followed by conversion to Roth. At \$7,500 each for 2026, both spouses can position \$15,000 for tax-free growth.

How It Works:

1. Contribute \$7,500 to Traditional IRA (non-deductible due to income limits)
2. Convert immediately to Roth IRA (minimal tax on any gains if done quickly)
3. File Form 8606 with tax return to document the non-deductible contribution

Eligibility Criteria: Must have no existing Traditional IRA balances for cleanest conversion (pro-rata rule applies if Traditional IRAs exist). You both have Roth IRAs, which is ideal.

The Backdoor Roth requires precise execution. Verify you have no Traditional IRA balances with your CPA before proceeding. 2026 limit: \$7,500 per spouse.

Strategy Concept: Home Office Deduction

Potential Value: \$396 - \$792 tax savings

What It Is: Self-employed individuals can deduct the business-use portion of home expenses. You indicated a dedicated area (not a full room) used regularly and exclusively for LLC business. Using the simplified method: $300 \text{ sq ft} \times \$5 = \$1,500$ maximum deduction $\times 26.4\% = \$396$ tax savings. Actual expense method may yield higher deduction.

How It Works:

1. Measure dedicated workspace square footage (simplified method caps at 300 sq ft)
2. Option 1 (Simplified): \$5/sq ft, max \$1,500 deduction
3. Option 2 (Actual): Calculate percentage of home used $\times$ actual home expenses

Eligibility Criteria: Self-employment income (LLC qualifies); regular and exclusive business use of space.

Take photos documenting dedicated workspace. Verify method selection with your CPA. Deduction limited to net self-employment income.

Strategy Concept: Vehicle Mileage Deduction (72.5¢/mile for 2026)

Potential Value: \$287 - \$575 tax savings

What It Is: Business miles driven for the LLC can be deducted at the IRS standard mileage rate. You indicated occasional business use (under 25%) of the Toyota Sequoia. At 1,500-3,000 business miles $\times$ 72.5¢ = \$1,088-\$2,175 deduction $\times$ 26.4% = \$287-\$575 tax savings.

How It Works:

1. Begin tracking all business miles immediately using app (MileIQ, Everlance, Stride)
2. Document: date, destination, business purpose, miles driven
3. Commuting miles are NOT deductible; only miles for business purposes (travel to training sites, supply runs, etc.)

Eligibility Criteria: Self-employment with vehicle used for business; contemporaneous mileage log required for audit defense.

Mileage rate for 2026: 72.5¢/mile (up from 70¢ in 2025). Start tracking now. Discuss with your CPA.

Strategy Concept: Augusta Rule (14-Day Rental)

Potential Value: \$1,320 - \$1,848 tax savings

What It Is: IRC Section 280A allows renting your home to your business for up to 14 days per year with income received tax-free to you personally. The business deducts the rent as a business expense. At 10 days $\times$ \$500-\$700/day = \$5,000-\$7,000 rental income (tax-free) and business deduction $\times$ 26.4% = \$1,320-\$1,848 tax savings.

How It Works:

1. Document fair rental value (research comparable venue rentals in Fort Collins)
2. Hold legitimate business meetings, trainings, or planning sessions at home
3. Create rental agreement between you and the LLC; document each use with meeting minutes
4. LLC pays rent to you; you receive tax-free, LLC gets deduction

Eligibility Criteria: Business purpose required; must document fair market rental rate; limited to 14 days per year.

Augusta Rule requires careful documentation. Obtain comparable rental rates. Discuss implementation with your CPA before proceeding.

Strategy Concept: Colorado 529 State Deduction

Potential Value: \$18 - \$44 tax savings

What It Is: Colorado allows a state income tax deduction for 529 plan contributions. You currently contribute \$50/quarter per child (\$400/year total). Increasing to \$1,000/year $\times$ 4.4% CO rate = \$44 state tax savings. While small, it builds college savings while reducing state taxes.

How It Works:

1. Increase automatic contributions to 529 plans as cash flow allows
2. Colorado has no annual limit on deductible contributions
3. Funds grow tax-free when used for qualified education expenses

Eligibility Criteria: Colorado resident; contributions to any 529 plan qualify for CO deduction.

Consider timing of contributions around cash flow constraints. Discuss with your CPA.

Strategy Concept: Section 179 Equipment Deduction

Potential Value: \$528 - \$2,640 tax savings (as needed)

What It Is: Section 179 allows immediate expensing of business equipment purchases rather than depreciation over time. You indicated moderate equipment purchases (\$2,000-\$10,000) for the LLC. At \$2,000-\$10,000 $\times$ 26.4% = \$528-\$2,640 potential tax savings in the year of purchase.

How It Works:

1. Purchase equipment needed for LLC operations (training materials, CPR mannequins, technology, etc.)
2. Equipment must be used >50% for business
3. Deduct full cost in year of purchase (up to net business income)

Eligibility Criteria: Self-employment income; equipment used primarily for business; 2026 Section 179 limit: \$1,220,000.

Only purchase equipment you genuinely need. Keep receipts and document business use. Discuss with your CPA.

Primary Strategy Focus: Retirement Account Optimization

Based on your profile, the highest-impact opportunity appears to be maximizing tax-advantaged retirement account contributions. Your household has access to both 457(b) and 403(b) plans, which can be contributed to simultaneously with separate limits. This is uncommon and represents a significant advantage.

Combined Retirement Contribution Potential (2026)

Account	Owner	2026 Limit	Current Contribution	Potential Tax Savings
457(b) Deferred Comp	Ryan	\$24,500	\$0 (unused)	\$6,468 at 26.4%
403(b)	Jeanette	\$24,500	~\$2,640/yr (est.)	\$3,168-\$6,468
Backdoor Roth IRA	Both	\$15,000 combined	Roth already used	Tax-free growth
Maximum Combined		\$64,000	—	~\$12,936

⚠️ 457(b) vs 401(k) Key Difference

Unlike 401(k) and 403(b) plans, the 457(b) has **NO 10% early withdrawal penalty** before age 59½. This makes it an excellent vehicle for early retirement planning. Funds can be withdrawn (with ordinary income tax) at any age after separation from service.

Consideration: If early retirement before age 59½ is a goal, prioritizing 457(b) contributions provides more flexibility than 403(b) contributions.

Cash Flow Consideration

With current college support obligations (~\$4,075/month) and fixed expenses, maximizing all accounts simultaneously may strain cash flow. A phased approach may be more practical:

Phase	Timeframe	Focus	Monthly Impact
Phase 1	Now - Son's graduation	Ryan: Start 457(b) at 10% (\$1,500-2,000/mo) Jeanette: Maintain current 403(b)	~\$1,500-\$2,000 reduction in take-home
Phase 2	After college costs end	Ryan: Increase 457(b) toward max Jeanette: Increase 403(b)	Redirect freed college funds
Phase 3	After car payoff (\$293/mo)	Maximize both accounts Add Backdoor Roth IRAs	Additional capacity

This phased approach is one potential implementation sequence. Discuss timing and amounts with your CPA and financial advisor based on your complete cash flow picture.

Ryan's 457(b) Fee Investigation

You mentioned avoiding the 457(b) when Ryan started 26 years ago due to high fees. Fee structures have changed dramatically in municipal retirement plans over the past two decades. Common improvements include:

- Lower expense ratio index funds now commonly available (often 0.05%-0.25%)
- Reduced or eliminated administrative fees
- Target-date funds as low-cost options

Suggested Discussion Point: Request a current fee schedule and investment option list from Denver Fire HR. Compare expense ratios to your existing Roth IRA investments.

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Illustrative Portfolio Scenario

Profile Analysis: Based on your responses indicating "moderately aggressive" investment approach (Q41), goals focused on "decreasing taxes and making better money" (Q46), and 2-5 hours available weekly (Q44), this scenario models a growth-oriented approach with Bitcoin as a core position and income-generating assets for passive cash flow.

Capital Basis: Q45 indicated \$5-10K comfortable deploying. Conservative scenario uses \$7,500 (midpoint); aggressive scenario uses \$15,000 (upper range plus potential freed cash flow).

Educational Allocation Scenario

Asset Class	Scenario %	Conservative (\$7,500)	Aggressive (\$15,000)	Educational Rationale
Bitcoin	60%	\$4,500	\$9,000	Core wealth accumulation vehicle due to fixed 21M supply cap and increasing institutional adoption trajectory. Moderately aggressive profile supports growth focus. Already using River Financial DCA.
STRC	30%	\$2,250	\$4,500	Bitcoin-correlated income vehicle providing approximately 10-12% yield. Addresses passive income goal while maintaining Bitcoin exposure. Passive nature aligns with limited time availability.
VTI/VOO	10%	\$750	\$1,500	Broad U.S. equity exposure at low cost (0.03% expense ratio). Provides diversification and traditional portfolio balance. Complements Bitcoin position.

Projected Returns (Illustrative)

Asset	Conservative Return	Aggressive Return	Notes
Bitcoin	25%	50%	Highly volatile; historical performance varies widely
STRC Yield	10%	12%	Verify current yield at time of investment
STRC Appreciation	15%	30%	Bitcoin-correlated; moves with BTC price

VTI/VOO	8%	12%	Long-term historical average ~10%
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Product Education

- **Bitcoin:** Bitcoin serves as a wealth accumulation vehicle due to its fixed 21M supply and increasing institutional adoption. You've already begun accumulating via River Financial's DCA feature.
- **STRC:** STRC is commonly used by investors seeking passive income with Bitcoin correlation, providing approximately 10-12% annual yield. It offers Bitcoin exposure with income generation.
- **VTI:** VTI (Vanguard Total Stock Market ETF) provides broad U.S. equity exposure at low cost (0.03% expense ratio), holding 4,000+ stocks.
- **VOO:** VOO tracks the S&P 500, offering exposure to 500 of the largest U.S. companies at 0.03% expense ratio.

This scenario models one approach based on the moderately aggressive profile and growth-focused goals indicated. Investment values shown are illustrative projections based on assumptions stated. All investments carry risk including potential loss of principal. Bitcoin and cryptocurrency are highly volatile and speculative. Specific investment decisions should be made in consultation with a licensed financial advisor who understands your complete situation.

Modeled First-Year Value Summary (2026 Tax Year)

Capital Deployment Basis:

- **Conservative:** \$7,500 (Q45 midpoint: \$5-10K comfortable deploying)
- **Aggressive:** \$15,000 (upper range + potential freed cash flow)

Category	Item	Conservative	Aggressive	Calculation Notes
CATEGORY A: TAX OPTIMIZATION STRATEGIES				
Tax	457(b) Contribution (Ryan)	\$6,468	\$6,468	\$24,500 × 26.4% marginal rate
Tax	403(b) Contribution (Jeanette)	\$3,168	\$6,468	\$12,000-\$24,500 × 26.4%
Tax	Home Office Deduction	\$396	\$792	\$1,500-\$3,000 deduction × 26.4%
Tax	Vehicle Mileage (72.5¢/mi)	\$287	\$575	1,500-3,000 mi × 72.5¢ × 26.4%
Tax	Augusta Rule (14-day rental)	\$1,320	\$1,848	10 days × \$500-\$700 × 26.4%
Tax	529 Colorado Deduction	\$18	\$44	\$400-\$1,000 × 4.4% state rate
	Tax Optimization Subtotal	\$11,657	\$16,195	
CATEGORY B: INVESTMENT INCOME (Yield/Dividends)				
Income	STRC Yield (10-12%)	\$225	\$540	\$2,250 × 10% / \$4,500 × 12%
Income	ETF Dividends (1.5-2%)	\$11	\$30	\$750 × 1.5% / \$1,500 × 2%
	Investment Income Subtotal	\$236	\$570	
CATEGORY C: INVESTMENT APPRECIATION (Projected Growth)				
Growth	Bitcoin Appreciation (25-50%)	\$1,125	\$4,500	\$4,500 × 25% / \$9,000 × 50%
Growth	STRC Appreciation (15-30%)	\$338	\$1,350	\$2,250 × 15% / \$4,500 × 30%

Category	Item	Conservative	Aggressive	Calculation Notes
Growth	VTI/VOO Appreciation (8-12%)	\$60	\$180	$\$750 \times 8\% / \$1,500 \times 12\%$
	Appreciation Subtotal	\$1,523	\$6,030	
CATEGORY D: REAL ESTATE				
RE	STR/LTR Cash Flow	\$0	\$0	Capital insufficient for ownership currently
RE	Property Appreciation	\$0	\$0	Consider arbitrage/co-hosting as 6-12 mo goal
RE	Mortgage Paydown	\$0	\$0	—
	Real Estate Subtotal	\$0	\$0	Future opportunity when capital available
CATEGORY E: CASH FLOW IMPROVEMENTS				
Cash Flow	W-4 Optimization	\$0	\$1,200	Potential \$100/mo $\times$ 12 if overwithholding
Cash Flow	Car Loan Interest Savings	\$0	\$1,020	$\$17K \times \sim 6\%$ if paid off early
	Cash Flow Subtotal	\$0	\$2,220	
CATEGORY F: WEALTH BUILDING (Dollars Positioned)				
Wealth	403(b) Contributions (Jeanette)	\$12,000	\$24,500	2026 limit: \$24,500 (age 48, no catch-up)
Wealth	457(b) Contributions (Ryan)	\$24,500	\$24,500	2026 limit: \$24,500 (age 48, no catch-up)
Wealth	Backdoor Roth IRA (both)	\$15,000	\$15,000	$\$7,500 \times 2$ spouses
Wealth	Augusta Rule Income Received	\$5,000	\$7,000	Tax-free income (14-day rule)
Wealth	Investment Capital Deployed	\$7,500	\$15,000	New investment positions

Category	Item	Conservative	Aggressive	Calculation Notes
	Wealth Building Subtotal	\$64,000	\$86,000	
TOTAL FIRST-YEAR VALUE (2026)		\$77,416	\$111,015	

Totals Verification

Category	Conservative	Aggressive
A: Tax Optimization	\$11,657	\$16,195
B: Investment Income	\$236	\$570
C: Investment Appreciation	\$1,523	\$6,030
D: Real Estate	\$0	\$0
E: Cash Flow	\$0	\$2,220
F: Wealth Building	\$64,000	\$86,000
GRAND TOTAL	\$77,416	\$111,015

Important: Projected values are illustrative estimates for the 2026 tax year based on assumptions stated. Investment appreciation is based on historical performance patterns and is not guaranteed—past performance does not guarantee future results. All investments carry risk including potential loss of principal. Bitcoin and cryptocurrency are highly volatile. Tax savings shown use 2026 IRS limits; verify eligibility with your CPA. Consult with your licensed professionals before implementation.

Calendar Awareness & Key Dates (2026)

Date	Item	Notes
April 15, 2026	2025 IRA/Roth IRA contribution deadline	Last day to make 2025 contributions (\$7,000/person)
April 15, 2026	2025 HSA contribution deadline	Not applicable (no HDHP)
October 2026	457(b) Open Enrollment	Ryan: Denver Fire deferred comp opens October; review annually
December 31, 2026	2026 401(k)/403(b)/457(b) contribution deadline	Employee contributions must be made by Dec 31
December 31, 2026	Augusta Rule usage	All 14 rental days must occur within calendar year
December 31, 2026	Section 179 purchases	Equipment must be placed in service by year-end
April 15, 2027	2026 IRA/Roth IRA contribution deadline	\$7,500/person for 2026

Quarterly Review Checkpoints

- **Q1 2026 (Jan-Mar):** Finalize 2025 contributions; begin 457(b) enrollment process; implement mileage tracking
- **Q2 2026 (Apr-Jun):** File taxes; execute Backdoor Roth for 2026; review 403(b) contribution levels post-tax filing
- **Q3 2026 (Jul-Sep):** Mid-year contribution check; Augusta Rule planning; assess college cost changes
- **Q4 2026 (Oct-Dec):** 457(b) open enrollment; year-end tax planning; ensure all contributions are on track

Verify all deadlines with your tax professional. Dates shown are for general awareness and may not reflect extensions or special circumstances.

Questions for Your Professional Team

Questions for Your CPA

Ask your CPA: "Based on our income and filing status, what are our maximum 2026 retirement contributions across all accounts (403b, 457b, Roth)?"

Ask your CPA: "Can we still make 2025 IRA contributions before April 15, 2026? What's the best approach given our income?"

Ask your CPA: "For the Backdoor Roth IRA strategy, do either of us have any Traditional IRA balances that would trigger pro-rata issues?"

Ask your CPA: "What documentation do I need for the Augusta Rule to withstand audit scrutiny?"

Ask your CPA: "Should I use simplified or actual expense method for my home office deduction?"

Ask your CPA: "With our son's college support, should we claim him as a dependent, or is it better for him to file independently?"

Questions for Your Financial Advisor

Discuss with advisor: "Given our \$600K in Roths, how does adding 457(b) and 403(b) contributions change our tax diversification strategy?"

Discuss with advisor: "What investment options are available in Ryan's 457(b) plan, and how do fees compare to our Roth accounts?"

Discuss with advisor: "How should we think about sequence of contributions given our cash flow constraints?"

Discuss with advisor: "At age 48, what's our optimal mix of pre-tax (457b, 403b) vs. after-tax (Roth) savings?"

Questions for HR Departments

Ryan - Ask Denver Fire HR: "Can I get a current fee schedule and investment option list for the 457(b) plan?"

Jeanette - Ask employer HR: "What's my current 403(b) contribution percentage, and how do I increase it?"

Both: "Are there any employer matching contributions I'm not currently capturing?"

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Professional Team Considerations

Professional	Role	When Needed
CPA / Tax Professional	Verify eligibility for all tax strategies; prepare returns; ensure compliance with IRS rules; coordinate retirement contributions	Before implementing any strategy; tax filing; major financial changes
Financial Advisor (Fiduciary)	Investment selection; portfolio construction; retirement planning; goal alignment	Before investing; 457(b) investment selection; periodic reviews
Estate Planning Attorney	Beneficiary designations; wills; trusts; asset protection	With \$600K+ in Roths, ensure proper beneficiary designations and estate documents
Insurance Agent	Review life, disability, liability coverage adequacy	Annual review; after wealth increases

 Do-It-Yourself Tax Note

You mentioned doing taxes yourself for the family and businesses. As your situation becomes more complex with retirement optimization, Augusta Rule, and potentially future real estate, consider:

- At minimum, a one-time CPA consultation to review strategy implementation
- CPA review of returns before filing, even if you prepare them
- Professional preparation may save more in optimizations than the fee costs

Milestone Checkpoints

Milestone	Target Timeframe	Key Indicators
Retirement Account Optimization	By December 2026	457(b) enrolled and contributing; 403(b) increased; Backdoor Roths executed
Business Deduction Documentation	Ongoing throughout 2026	Mileage log current; Augusta Rule documented; home office measured
College Expense Transition	6-18 months	Son graduates; ~\$4,075/mo freed for reallocation
Car Loan Completion	Est. 4-5 years	\$293/mo payment eliminated; funds redirected
Investment Portfolio Established	By Q2 2026	New capital deployed per scenario; tracking system in place
Real Estate Education	6-12 months	Arbitrage/co-hosting research complete; capital accumulating for future opportunity

Milestones are suggested checkpoints for discussion with your professional team. Actual timing depends on your specific circumstances and cash flow.

Educational Resources

2026 IRS Contribution Limits Reference

Account Type	Base Limit	Catch-Up (50+)	Super Catch-Up (60-63)
401(k) / 403(b) / 457(b) Employee	\$24,500	+\$8,000	+\$11,250
401(k) Total (Employee + Employer)	\$72,000	+\$8,000	+\$11,250
HSA (Family Coverage)	\$8,750	+\$1,000 (55+)	N/A
HSA (Individual Coverage)	\$4,400	+\$1,000 (55+)	N/A
Traditional / Roth IRA	\$7,500	+\$1,100	N/A

Business mileage rate for 2026: 72.5¢/mile. Verify all limits with IRS.gov or your tax professional.

Key IRS Publications

Publication 463	Travel, Gift, and Car Expenses (mileage deduction)
Publication 587	Business Use of Your Home
Publication 590-A	Contributions to IRAs
Publication 590-B	Distributions from IRAs
Publication 970	Tax Benefits for Education (529 plans)
Form 8606	Nondeductible IRAs (required for Backdoor Roth)

SECURE 2.0 Act Notes (2026 Provisions)

- Super Catch-Up (Ages 60-63):** Starting 2025, individuals ages 60-63 can contribute additional \$11,250 (instead of \$8,000) to 401(k)/403(b)/457(b) plans. You'll be eligible at age 60.
- Roth Catch-Up Mandate:** High earners (\$150K+ FICA wages in prior year) must make catch-up contributions as Roth starting 2026. Not currently applicable to you at age 48.
- Emergency Savings:** Employers may offer emergency savings accounts linked to retirement plans.

For educational reference only. Tax laws change frequently. Verify current rules with your CPA.

Important Disclaimers

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Not Tax Advice: Tax strategies discussed are educational explanations of how certain provisions work. Eligibility, implementation, and actual tax outcomes depend on your specific circumstances and must be verified by a qualified CPA or tax attorney before implementation.

Not Legal Advice: Entity structure, asset protection, and partnership discussions are educational. Consult a qualified attorney for legal guidance specific to your situation.

No Guarantees: Projected values, potential savings, and scenario outcomes are illustrative estimates based on assumptions stated. Actual results will vary based on market conditions, tax law changes, and individual circumstances. Past performance does not guarantee future results.

Investment Risk Disclosure: All investments involve risk. Bitcoin and cryptocurrency investments are highly volatile and speculative. Real estate investments carry risks including market fluctuations, vacancy, and unexpected expenses. You could lose some or all of your invested capital.

Tax Law Changes: Tax laws change regularly. Information presented reflects understanding as of February 2026 using 2026 IRS limits. Verify current rules with your tax professional.

Professional Consultation Required: Before implementing any strategy discussed in this document, consult with qualified licensed professionals including a CPA, attorney, and/or registered investment adviser who understand your complete financial situation.

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